

School of Computing and Information Systems

ISYS90045 Professional Skills in IS Consulting

End of Semester 1 2019

Reading Time: 15 minutes

Writing time: 120 minutes

This paper has 6 pages including this page.

Authorised Materials

Dictionaries: Paper based language translation dictionaries are permitted provided they are not annotated in any way.

Instructions to Invigilators

- The examination paper MAY NOT BE TAKEN from the examination room
- Students are to be provided with 1 script book
- Provide extra script books on request

Instructions to Students

- The total marks for this examination is 40
- Ensure your student number is written on all script books during writing time
- The examination consists of 6 questions. Some questions have multiple parts.
- You should answer FOUR 4 questions. Each question is worth 10 Marks.
- Answer all questions on the right-hand lined pages of the script book
- Start the answer to each question on a new page in the script book
- The left-hand unlined pages of script books are for notes and will not be marked
- Write legibly in blue or black pen or pencil
- Mobile phones, tablets, laptops, and other electronic devices, wallets and purses must be placed beneath your desk.
- All electronic devices (including mobile phones and phone alarms) must be switched off and remain under your desk until you leave the examination venue. No items may be taken to the toilet.

Paper to be lodged with Baillieu Library

Q1. Unstructured Problem Solving

Read the following scenario and answer ALL of the embedded questions: A and B.

As a consultant that has recently implemented a Geo Information System (GIS) you have received quite a bit of media attention and some 2nd level referrals, one of which is a new player in the fast fashion industry “Of The Moment (OTM)” and is expanding very rapidly. The company is opening new large stores every 3 months. Management at OTM now want to gather a lot more data about their customers and their shopping habits. They come to you with an idea of implementing a GIS for their expansion plans. Management at OTM has heard that GIS are systems that use technology to analyze and display data for planning and decision making in the form of digitized maps. They have also found that understanding what is special about individual locations (based on the maps) provides the mechanisms to improve the effectiveness and efficiency of retail operations. This localisation helps bring the right amount of goods and services to the correct place at the best time and price to meet market demand and fulfil potential. Tailoring product offerings to shoppers on a store by store basis is more effective than a 1 size fits all approach.

What you know about GIS’s is that they can best be used to support decisions that require knowledge about the geographic distribution of people or other resources in scientific research, resource management, and development planning. GIS have modelling capabilities, allowing managers to change data and automatically revise business scenarios to find better solutions. For instance, the company could display its customers on a map based on postcode and then design the most convenient locations to put its stores.

The company is quite excited about this idea and has come to you to ask for help to solve this problem. Should the OTM implement a GIS to support improving customer needs?

- (A) Is this problem an unstructured or structured problem? Why? (1 Mark)
- (B) What framework would you use to help OTM understand their problem? Identify each step in the process and outline how each step would apply to the problem. (9 Marks)

Q2. Engagement Lifecycle

Read the following scenario and answer ALL of the embedded questions: A and B.

You’re scrolling LinkedIn while waiting for your train into the city which is delayed 7 minutes. You notice a post from a well-known hospitality group that are looking to upgrade their Point of Sale (POS) and/or Point of Purchase (POP) systems which would be rolled out to many of the cafes and restaurants in their chain. The upgrade would also include better inventory management, keep track of the customer’s orders, manage their restaurant tabs and integrate into third party systems such as payroll, scheduling and rostering, linen and cleaning suppliers. You can identify a huge opportunity for your consultancy if you were to win this work. You arrive at work and make a time to see the Partner about this potential

opportunity, the Partner congratulates you on finding the opportunity and puts you in charge of “winning the work”!

- (A) What are 5 key stages in an engagement lifecycle? (2.5 Marks)
- (B) What key activities do you perform in each stage and how is this relevant to the work you may be undertaking for the hospitality group? (7.5 Marks)

Q3. Closing out the engagement

Read the following scenario and answer ALL of the embedded questions: A, B and C.

You're the senior manager who is just coming to the end of a long and complicated engagement for a business that is an importer of Premium Olive Oil and Balsamic vinegar. On the engagement there have been regulatory hurdles with the Food and Safety regulators that you've had to satisfy that the product is safe for consumption and has been transported at the correct temperature and stored appropriately. You've had brand issues as the packaging of the imported Olive Oil is very similar to that of the locally produced Olive Oil which has caused confusion for customers. Because of the efficient systems the imported Olive Oil can be sold in Australia for much less than the local products causing customers to query the quality of the product rather than that it being produced very efficiently which means it's less expensive. Despite these hurdles, the product is now available in many supermarkets and grocery stores around the country and you have documented this all very carefully in the final deliverable which is a report. You are very pleased to be at the end of the engagement, but before you move onto the next engagement (nothing to do with olive oil) there is a close out phase that needs completing.

- (A) What are the key activities and steps that you will need to take in order to successfully close out the engagement? (5 Marks)
- (B) Will the Partner need to review the final report? Why/ Why not? (2 Marks)
- (C) What are three issues faced if this is project were to fail? (3 Marks)

Q4. Risk

Read the following scenario and answer ALL of the embedded questions: A, B and C.

You're the Risk Analyst for *Risky Business* – an IT Consulting Firm specialising in IT Project Management and Risk, and are often called into projects to provide Subject Matter Expertise on matters of Risk and Risk Management. Today, you've been called in to advise a project team on matters of Risk Management before they engage the client. You expect that it will be a quick talk, but soon find that there is little, to no risk management in the project at all. Looks like you have to start from the basics.

- (A) What is the definition of "Risk", as we used it in the lectures of this subject? (1 Mark)
- (B) What are 4 primary ways to manage risk? Offer a short definition of each. (4 Marks)

Having now communicated the essentials of Risk Management to the project team, the manager pulls you aside and asks you to take a quick look at some of the content from their information gathering phase.

“The client is a small IT company, “ForgeddaBout IT” (FBIT) -- they outsource IT and technical support expertise to medium size organisations who don’t have the need for a full IT department. They have 87 staff spread across 11 different organisations. They have engaged your Consulting Firm because they’re looking to expand and want to make sure their infrastructure can accommodate an abrupt series of changes.

At present, they have 3 central databases, operating as a *Cloud*, which host a variety of data from different clients, including Payroll, Customer Data, and assorted files; though it seems that none of them are dedicated for a specific purpose or data-type. These databases are all managed by one DBA (Database Administrator) named Geoff, who has been at the company since its founding. He was extraordinarily helpful in providing this information, and knew just about everything the consultants needed to know, managing to pull even the most granular logs by logging in as the SYSTEM user; even boasting that he is the only one who knows the ins and outs of the systems.

These databases are routinely accessed by FBIT’s clients, who can upload and download data as they need. Though they have 11 clients, one of the business managers mentioned proudly that they service two of the Big-four Banks, both of whom – he says – have commented on how pleased they are with the up-time of all their services. He manages both accounts personally. It is so good, in fact, that they don’t even need SLAs, or a business continuity plan for downtime. He also mentions that he’s the go-to guy for both Bank’s data management solutions in the company. The banks have requested dedicated infrastructure, but it’s cheaper to merge them into a single cloud instance, and much easier to support their up-time requirements, so FBIT has opted for that option instead.”

- (C) Identify and discuss 5 Risks in the client notes; explain why you think they are risks and their inherent ramifications. (5 Marks)

Q5. Governance

Read the following scenario and answer ALL of the embedded questions: A, B and C.

You’re a Senior Manager for *Sovereign Advisory* – an IT Consulting Firm specialising GRC (Governance, Risk and Compliance). For the last month, you’ve been working on a project building a Governance model in a rapidly growing, Technology company “BSOD” that builds software solutions for large enterprises; the company was born out of a start-up incubator and retains much of its unstructured agile culture.

You’ve been brought in because BSOD wants to bid for Government software projects, and they’ve encountered some problems. You’ve had cursory conversations with Sili Conbro, the Head of Crazy Ideas (who you understand is the CEO, though he rejects the title), who tells you that “GRC isn’t really our thing”, but you still managed to glean the following information from your interview:

“BSOD is looking to pursue the Government Software Development tenders, which would see them developing Software for high security environments. They have been told that they need a strong internal governance framework in order to be included in the tender, and that their current delivery solution –

which is 100% off-shore cloud dependant – would not satisfy the requirements. Upon questioning, you were unable to find the person responsible for the Cloud Delivery model, the CEO cited that “Here at BSOD, everyone does everything.” And you found a similar problem with all decision making; the team appears to seek consensus and share accountability accordingly; further to that, all decision making processes were “fast and loose”.

- (A) What is the definition of "Project Governance", as we used it in the lectures of this subject? (2 Marks)
- (B) Identify 3 aspects of BSOD which might benefit from organisational governance. (3 Marks)
- (C) Using your knowledge of Risk and your answers from Question (B), describe how a Governance Framework might support the management of Risk in these aspects. (5 Marks)

Q6. Proposals: Developing a Response

Read the following scenario and answer ALL of the embedded questions: A, B and C.

You are a Manager in the consulting firm “Wrap-IT-Up Solutions”. Your team specialises in providing business analytics, specialising in large information technology projects and initiatives. Your expertise is built on understanding the technology products and solutions being developed and implemented. However, your primary focus is on interviewing business teams to understand the work they perform and how their current processes will need to be transformed to support the implementation of new technology.

Just after getting to work on a Monday morning, your team’s lead partner, Giovanni, comes to you with an RFP (Request For Proposal) from UDP Package Logistics – a logistics company based in Melbourne Australia, they service and operate freight trucks that delivers mining equipment for Australia’s big minerals and resources companies. UDP Package Logistics is considering whether to upgrade its existing human resources and payroll system. The old system takes a whole day to run its automated payroll process to pay staff. The process for requesting holidays and sick days is burdensome and requires staff to send emails to their managers asking for approval to take time off work, then taking screenshots of the email approvals and uploaded these images to each leave request in the system (as the system does not allow staff to upload email messages, only image files). It would be much simpler to have the requests and approvals all in one system as part of a consistent workflow— a staff member enters the system to request leave, the manager receives a prompt to approve the leave, then approves or rejects the leave in the system itself.

The client has a long-term project in mind to perform this upgrade but has issued this RFP for a four-week discovery exercise to be performed. UDP Package Logistics wants to learn more about the current system’s problems and better understand the kinds of design features and tools that UDP Package Logistics staff want from their HR system. They expect this to be done by interviews and workshops.

Giovanni asks you to create the first draft of a proposal for him to review. He expects that there will be a brief kick-off meeting, a series of interviews and workshops to be held with UDP Package Logistics staff members, then a week for documenting and presenting a report containing your findings and suggestions for design features and products.

- (A) Using the definition supplied by the course material, answer what 'RFP' stands for and what does it mean? What are the other types of proposals that you might find and what are their definitions? (2 Marks)
- (B) You need to respond to Giovanni; what are the sections that you would typically include in a proposal of this sort? What is typically covered in each section? (3 Marks)
- (C) There are two methods of selling consulting services we discussed in class; what are they? Which would you use in your response to Giovanni? Provide an example of the how you would use the method you've selected. (5 Marks)

=====END OF EXAM=====